

What is a graph? [UDL-13]

Graphs coded into matrices

Graphs are powerful tools in modeling interactions/relationships between different elements. By modeling such dependencies/interactions in a reliable way, one can derive rules, predictions or new knowledge about the system in hand.

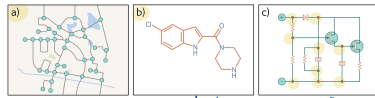


Figure 1 Real-world graphs. Some objects such as a) road networks, b) molecules, and c) electrical circuits are naturally structured as graphs.

- Social networks are graphs where nodes are people and the edges represent friendships between them.
- The scientific literature can be viewed as a graph in which the nodes are papers and the edges represent citations.
- Wikipedia can be thought of as a graph in which the nodes are articles and the edges represent hyperlinks between articles.
- Computer programs can be represented as graphs in which the nodes are syntax tokens (variables at different points in the program flow) and the edges represent computations involving these variables.
- Geometric point clouds can be represented as graphs. Here, each point is a node and has edges that connect to other nearby points.
- Protein interactions in a cell can be expressed as graphs, where the nodes are the proteins, and there is an edge between two proteins if they interact.

More examples

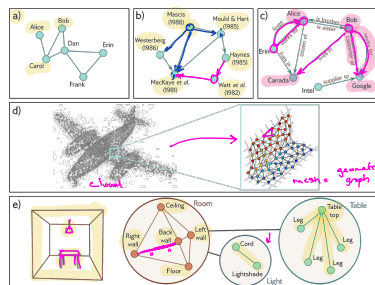


Figure 2 Types of graphs. a) A social network is an undirected graph; the connection between people are symmetric. b) A citation network is a directed graph; one publication cites another, so the relationship is asymmetric. c) A knowledge graph is a directed heterogeneous multigraph. The nodes are heterogeneous in that they represent different object types (people, places, companies) and there may be multiple edges representing different relations between each node. d) A point set can be converted to a graph by forming edges between nearby points. Each node has an associated position in 3D space and this is termed a geometric graph (adapted from Ili et al. 2021). e) The scene on the left can be represented by a hierarchical graph. The topology of the room, table, and light are all represented by graphs and these graphs form nodes in a larger graph representing object adjacency (adapted from Fernández-Madruga & González 2002).

Graph representation into a matrix

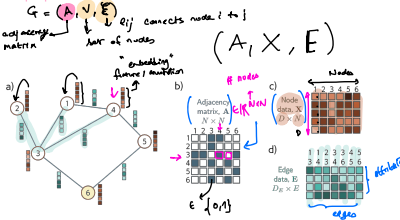
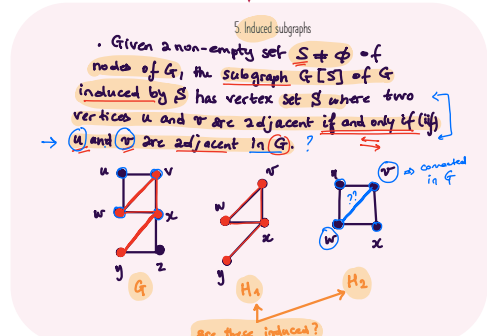
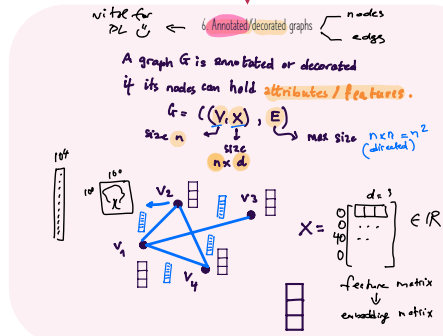
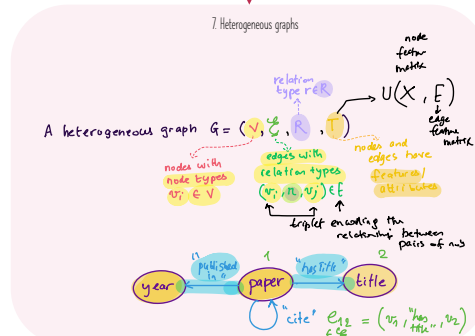
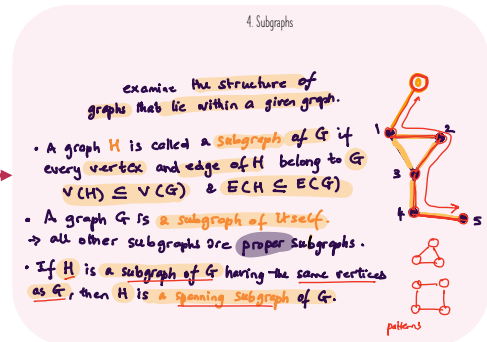
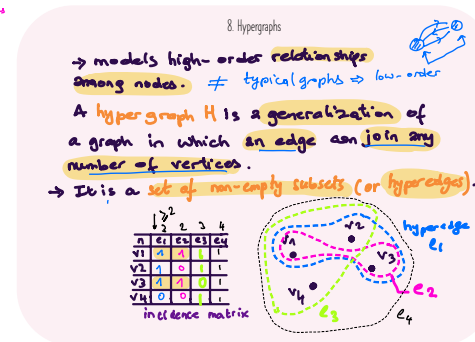
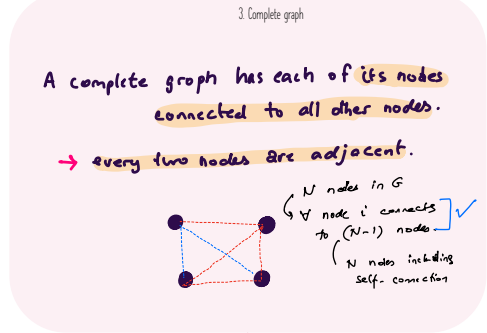
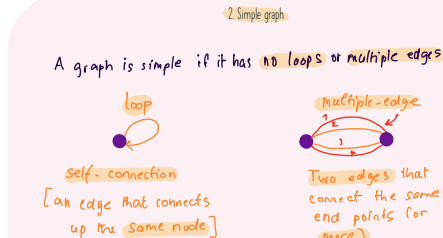
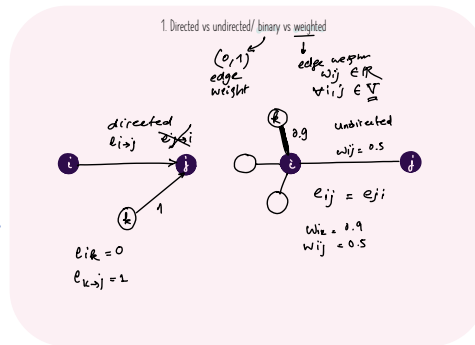
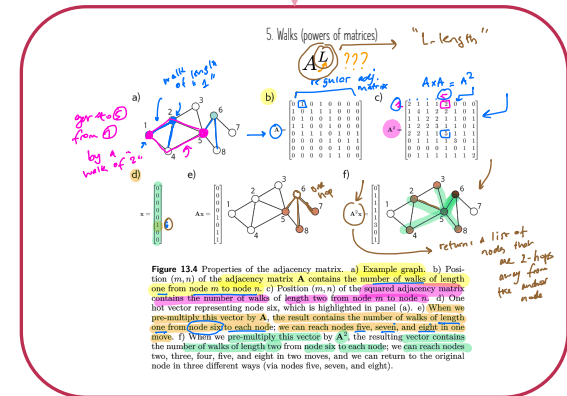
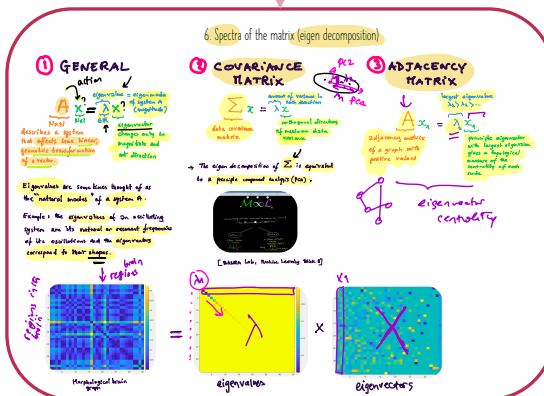
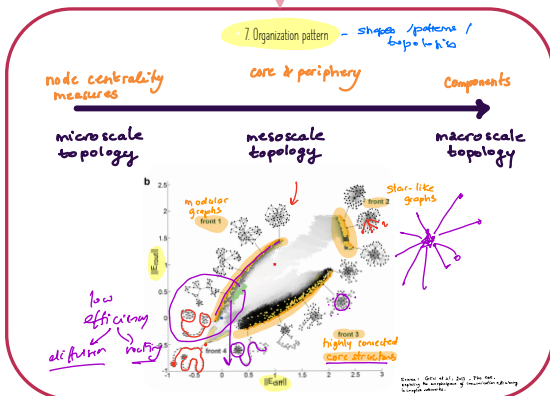
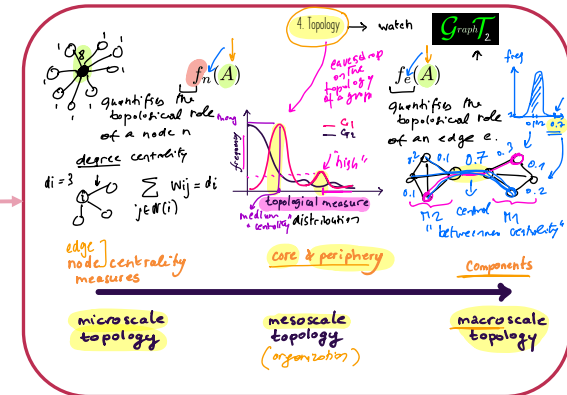
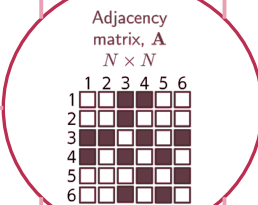
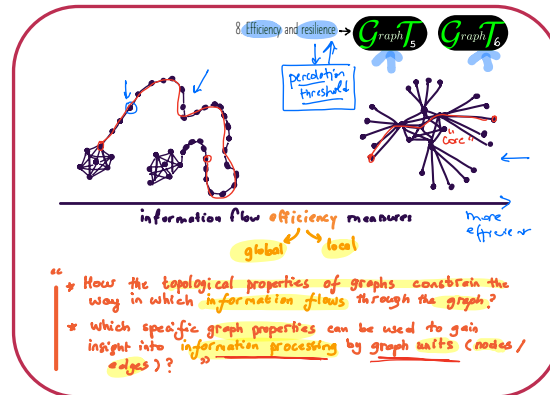
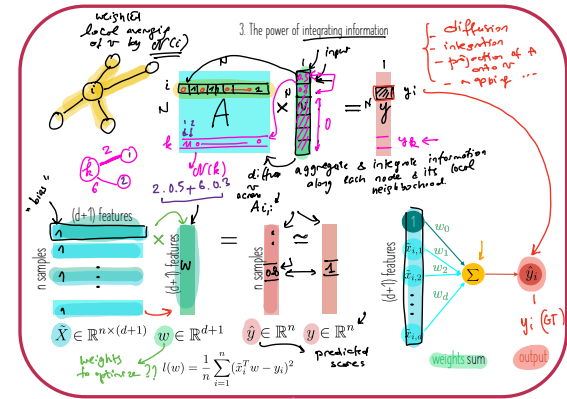
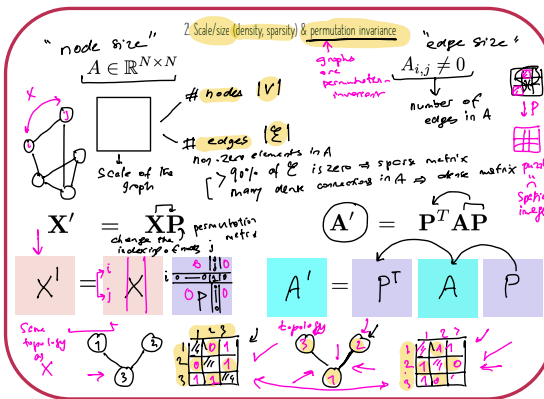
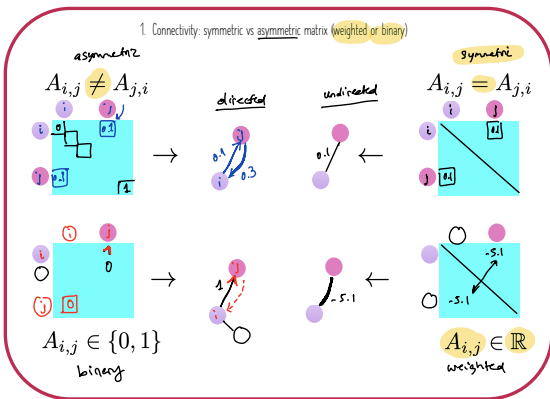


Figure 3 Graph representation into a matrix. a) Example graph with six nodes and seven edges. Each node has an associated embedding of length four (blue vectors). Each edge has an associated embedding of length four (blue vectors). This graph can be represented by three matrices. b) The adjacency matrix is a binary matrix where the element (m, n) is set to one if node m connects to node n . c) The node data matrix X contains the concatenated node embeddings. d) The edge data matrix E contains the edge embeddings.

Graph types



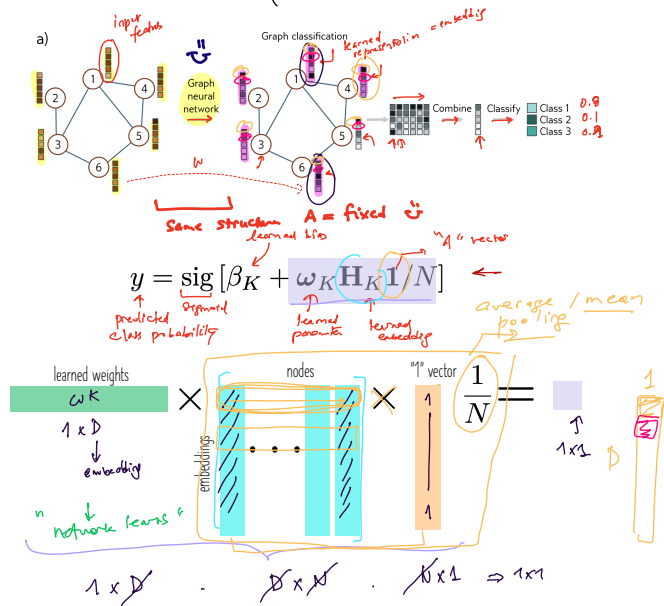
Graph (matrix) properties



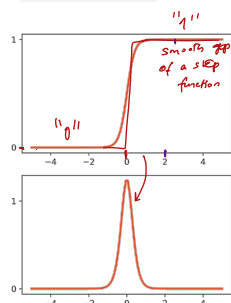
Learning tasks

Graph classification

Classify a graph (e.g., molecule $\begin{cases} \text{poisonous} \\ \text{or not} \end{cases}$)



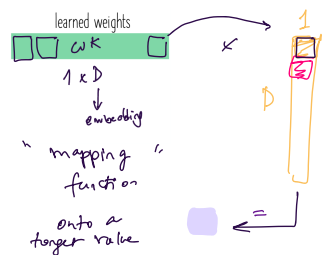
Logistic activation (sigmoid)



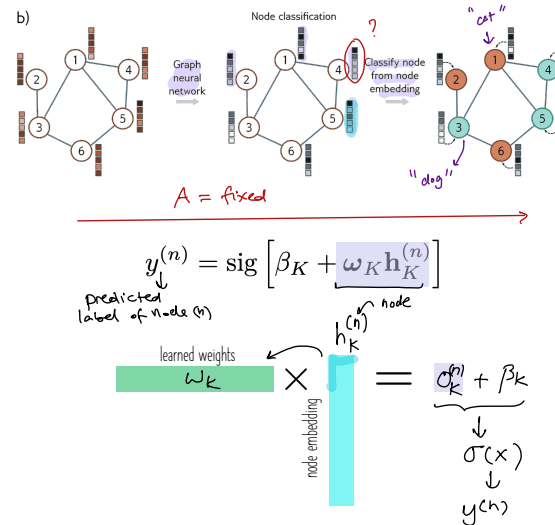
$$\sigma(x) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-x}}$$

classification

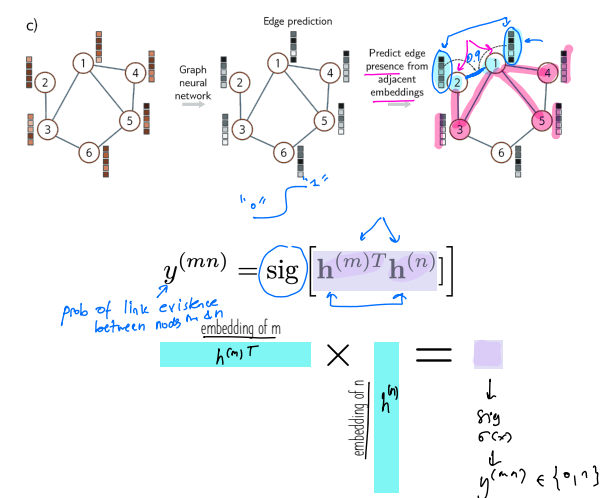
$$\frac{d}{dx} \sigma(x) = \sigma(x) \cdot (1 - \sigma(x))$$



Node classification



Edge prediction



Generalized $\begin{cases} \text{node-level} \\ \text{edge-level} \\ \text{graph-level} \end{cases}$ prediction

